

Lesli D. Perez Garcia

Open to Relocate | +1 (956) 996-0410 | lesliperezgar@gmail.com | [LinkedIn](#) | [Portfolio](#)

EDUCATION

The University of Texas Rio Grande Valley (UTRGV)

ABET Accredited

Master of Science in Computer Science - GPA: 3.70

2024 – 2025

B.S. in Computer Engineering, Minor in Asian Studies - GPA: 3.71

2019 – 2023

EXPERIENCE

Oak Ridge National Lab – ORISE

Knoxville, TN

Research Participant

June 2026 – End Date: December 2026

- Developing a Python CLI that interfaces with REST APIs to automate data parsing, processing, and retrieval.
- Executing quality assurance validation on five separate AI models to assess comparative performance.
- Developing a Unity AR application with real-time AI integration and controller/hand-based object interactions.
- Presented a poster to industry, academic, and national laboratory leaders at an internal research showcase.

UTRGV College of Engineering and Computer Science

Edinburg, TX

Research Assistant - MI@UTRGV

Sep 2023 – June 2024

- Analyzed AI and reinforcement learning algorithms to support innovative, data-driven projects.
- Developed and presented a [research proposal](#) on autonomous vehicles to CS professors and students.
- Implemented reinforcement learning experiments in Python to enhance recommender system performance.

Smart Technology Research Assistant - Department of Defense I-DREAM4D Consortium

May 2021 – May 2022

- Researched multi-laser AM open systems and contributed to hardware selection and integration.
- Added features to legacy code in VS using C# and ActiveX for the machine's translation stages and galvo system.

System Analyst Support

Feb 2023 – Feb 2024, June 2024 – Dec 2025

- Developed Bash scripts and documentation to automate user account creation with secure first-login password protocols, reducing manual processing by 90%.
- Installed and updated operating systems and software for university-managed computers.
- Upgraded computer systems from HDDs to SSDs, increasing performance by 2-5x and reducing downtime.

PROJECTS & ORGANIZATIONS

Computer Science Resource Hub

Edinburg, TX

Volunteer Web Developer ([GitHub Link](#))

April 2026 – June 2026

- Developed and deployed a web-based resource hub to support programming and AI education.
- Researched and evaluated AI-based tools, coding exercises, and debugging activities for programming and AI education.
- Built using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, VS Code, Git, GitHub, and GitHub Pages with AI-assisted development.

Fixer Uppers Website - Database Design

Edinburg, TX

Team Lead, Full-Stack Developer ([Project Link](#))

Feb 2025 – May 2025

- Led database and system design for a job-matching web app and developed E-R model and relational schema.
- Built and deployed core features using Next.js, JavaScript, CSS, and AWS.
- Designed system flows and UI to improve usability, reliability, and user engagement.

UTRGV College of Engineering and Computer Science Capstone Project

Edinburg, TX

Full-Stack App Developer ([GitHub Link](#))

Aug 2022 – May 2023

- Built Android app in Java with dual API integration that showcased real-time Arduino sensor data via Bluetooth.
- Designed aesthetic and user-friendly app interface with Figma.
- Debugged and improved Arduino and Java code continuously.

Tau Beta Pi Texas Nu - President, Social Media Manager, Member

Dec 2022 – Present

Rocket Launchers - Vice President, Telemetry Lead, Public Relations

Oct 2019 – May 2022

SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

Programming Languages & Frameworks: Python, C++, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Java, Arduino, Front-End & Back-End Development. Exposure to: R and Ruby

Development Tools: Jupyter Notebook, Git/GitHub, React, Flutter, SQLite, Jira, Asana, Figma, Miro